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GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

MARIA PLAZA casts a ballot at the Coalition for Humane Immigrant Rights voting center in L.A. on Friday.

Republicans could soon face a reckoning

Potential 'blue wave' may test the party's MAGA future and Trump's grip on it.

BY ANA CEBALLOS AND MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — The specter of a Democratic wave on Tuesday and retreat of Republican power has quietly sparked conversations within GOP circles about President Trump's eventual exit from the political stage — and the future of a party that has revolved around him for the last decade.

Heading into the vote, Trump faces the lowest job approval ratings of his career. Factions of the Republican Party long loyal to his brand are beginning to break ranks. Candidates who have aligned themselves most closely to the president are among the most imperiled.

From the shores of Lake Ontario to rural Kansas, signs point to a voter coalition under strain, as Republicans grappling with a troubled economy question the party's direction.

Recent polls show that 67% of Trump's 2024 voters approve of his job performance, down from 95% early in his second term.

The steepest drops are among younger voters and Latino support, according to a Pew Research Center poll.

Although a majority of Republicans still want to see

[See **Republicans,** A7]

Could it end up a 'dummymander'?

Republicans are about to find out whether their mid-decade gerrymanders backfired. **NATION, A6**



BRENDAN SMIALOWSKI AFP/Getty Images

MERCHANDISE is offered for sale as supporters listen to President Trump during a rally in Perry, Ga.

RULINGS STACK UP AGAINST ELECTION MEDDLING

Trump suffers a string of defeats in his efforts to wrest control of state voting processes.

BY KEVIN RECTOR

In a cascade of rulings in the days before Tuesday's elections, federal judges have rejected the Trump administration's efforts to wrest control over state voting processes, pressure state and local elections officials into complying with their demands and turn the midterm vote into another opportunity for immigration enforcement.

In Northern California late Friday, U.S. District Judge Trina L. Thompson granted labor unions representing California poll workers a sweeping order barring the Trump administration from an array of election-related actions, including demanding that those workers set aside ballots from voters whose eligibility the administration has questioned, and threatening them with criminal sanctions if they refuse to do so.

"Election Day is around the corner. Ballots have already been issued. Americans have already begun voting. Workers have already begun processing ballots," Thompson wrote. "Given the consequences of inaction, the Court sees no reason to delay its ruling."

[See **Rulings,** A7]

Alaska wants DOJ suit tossed

State's GOP attorney general asks judge to dismiss bid to halt vote certification. **NATION, A6**

HOLLYWOOD IN CRISIS

For Hollywood, grass is greener in Ireland

The Emerald Isle's many incentives are a major draw for American productions

By Stacy Perman

DUBLIN — Limerick, first settled by Vikings nearly 1,100 years ago, is a verdant sprawl of lush forests, rolling hills and liminal bogs.

But this region in midwest Ireland, steeped in folklore, where the River Shannon meets the estuary's tidal waters before emptying into the Atlantic Ocean, is also the unlikely site of bustling production activity.

In a technology park, not far from 13th century castles, medieval ruins and picturesque villages, stands Troy Studios. Opened nine years ago in a former Dell Computer factory that shut down when it shifted manufacturing to Poland, Troy is Ireland's biggest and newest soundstage complex.

It is here that Apple TV's science fiction series "Foundation," based on the Isaac Asimov masterpiece, was filmed, as was the SyFy horror series "Nightflyers," adapted from the works of George R. R. Martin. It's also where four prime-time American game shows are produced.

"It's cheaper to bring 100 American people to Ireland than to walk across the lot at Fox," actor Rob Lowe cracked on his podcast last year. Lowe is also the host of the trivia face-off show "The Floor," which relocated to Troy for its sixth and upcoming seventh seasons, after previously shooting at a studio south of Dublin.

While some in Ireland's fiercely proud film industry bristled at Lowe's comments, they were, in fact, a razor-sharp distillation of the pent-up frustration runaway production has engendered across the industry in Los Angeles.

Last year, 45% of all U.S. films and scripted television shows were shot internationally, up from about 33% in 2022.

As Hollywood productions have turned away from L.A., spanning the globe chasing tax credits and rebates, Ireland increasingly has become a destination for American movies, television series and the once-quintessentially L.A.

[See **Ireland,** A10]

ICE incident sparks outrage

Video shows a violent arrest, then an agent putting a gun to the face of a bystander.

BY SALVADOR HERNANDEZ

A video showing a federal officer pointing a gun inches from the face of a bystander during an immigration operation Friday in North Hollywood has sparked new outrage about the tactics being used in the Trump administration's ongoing crackdown.

The video, obtained by The Times, shows the masked federal agent shoving the man into bushes and pointing the handgun at his face after the bystander tossed a spray canister another agent had dropped into the street.

A statement from the Department of Homeland Security said agents were arresting Angel Luis Gonzalez Lobo, who had a final order of deportation, when he fled on foot from his vehicle.

On video, a bystander, who was walking two dogs down the street, came upon the scene.

According to the DHS account "a bystander armed with pepper spray encountered the officers, creating a moment of chaos in an otherwise controlled scene. These actions by these individuals created an unnecessarily dangerous, and precarious environment for federal law enforcement as they endeavored to carry out their lawful duties and effect an arrest."

Several law enforcement experts who reviewed the video said that while agents might have been justified in drawing a gun when the bystander reached for the spray canister, they could

[See **Video,** A8]

ICE OFFICER: Agent charged in incident in Texas to turn himself in. **NATION, A8**

In bitter mayoral contest, future of L.A. is on the line

BY DAVID ZAHNISER

It started with the February surprise.

Los Angeles City Councilmember Nithya Raman, a wonkish technocrat aligned with the Democratic Socialists of America, upended the race for mayor by launching a last-minute bid to unseat incumbent Karen Bass.

Bass, politically weakened over her handling of the devastating Palisades fire, has been on the defensive ever since. Yet she has remained in the fight, promoting her accomplishments on crime and affordable housing while amplifying the missteps made by Raman during the campaign's final weeks.

The two candidates are in a dead heat, according to the latest Berkeley IGS/L.A. Times poll, with a fifth of those surveyed still undecided.

"The question that the race comes down to, especially for undecided voters, is whether to stick with an unsatisfying status quo, or take the risk with a relatively unknown quantity who could make things better or worse," said Dan Schnur, who teaches political communications at USC and UC Berkeley.

The battle between Bass and Raman ends Tuesday, concluding a bitter nine-month contest between two candidates who were once political allies. Bass, 73, backed Raman during a tough reelection bid in 2024.

[See **Mayor,** A9]

Bass and Raman make final pitches

On a last weekend before the election, mayoral candidates mingle with the voters. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

75% of deceased NFL players in study had CTE

Authoritative new analysis underscores prevalence of brain disease in the sport

By Steve Henson

An analysis of the medical records of more than 2,000 deceased former NFL players estimates that a staggering 74.5% of them likely had chronic traumatic encephalopathy, a neurodegenerative brain disease tied to high-impact sports such as football.

Boston University has been on the forefront of diagnosing CTE for years and spearheaded the new study. Yet because the brain disease can be diagnosed only after death, conclusions from previous studies were marred by selection bias — a systematic error that occurs when those chosen for analysis do not properly represent the target population.

Eliminating selection bias was the impetus for the study published Wednesday in the medical journal JAMA Network Open that combined data from 2,362 players who died from 2008 to 2023. The total included 396 players who donated their brains and National Death Index records of 1,966 deceased players who didn't. Nearly 94% of the donated brains had CTE.

The 74.5% estimated prevalence was concerning and efforts to diagnose CTE during life must continue, said Julia Gallini, lead author of the study conducted by Mass General Brigham and the Concussion & CTE Foundation in addition to Boston University, in a statement.

[See **CTE,** A14]

A new museum nears liftoff

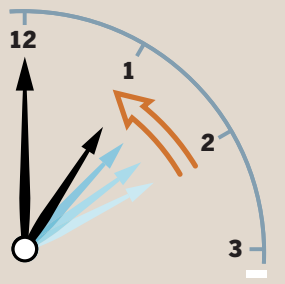
The Samuel Oschin Air and Space Center is an immersive experience. **ENTERTAINMENT, E2-7**

Harris stumps for Democrats

Former vice president urges party's donors and activists to "turn that anger into action." **PERSPECTIVES, A2**

Awaiting sea turtle egg hatch

Scientists are monitoring the eggs, which were deposited on Southern California beaches. **CALIFORNIA, B1**



Timely reminder

Daylight saving time ended Sunday at 2 a.m.

Weather

Some morning rain. L.A. Basin: 72/56. **B8**

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